

"Opponents of globalisation may see it as a new folly, but it is neither particularly new, nor, in general, a folly."

GLOBAL INDIAN

A brilliant economist, he has forced the engagement of the world with poverty, inequality and injustice, while also pointing to the moral compulsion and practical means of rectifying these social ills

■ By S. Subramanian

Amaritya Sen is only 14 years older than independent India so it is no surprise that his iconic status is so considerably wound up in the hopes, anxieties and pride of a young post-colonial country. His personal triumphs have been,

in large measure, also national triumphs. It has mattered to India and its citizens that Sen has been a brilliant and innovative economist; that he has forced the engagement of other professionals with subjects like poverty, inequality and development, which were earlier somewhat peripheral areas of

enquiry; that he is rooted without being chauvinist; that he is a citizen of the world who has not renounced his Indian passport; and that he is a cosmopolitan who is also a patriot. An aspect of Mahatma Gandhi's

Amartya Sen

Economist 1933

